FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 January 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

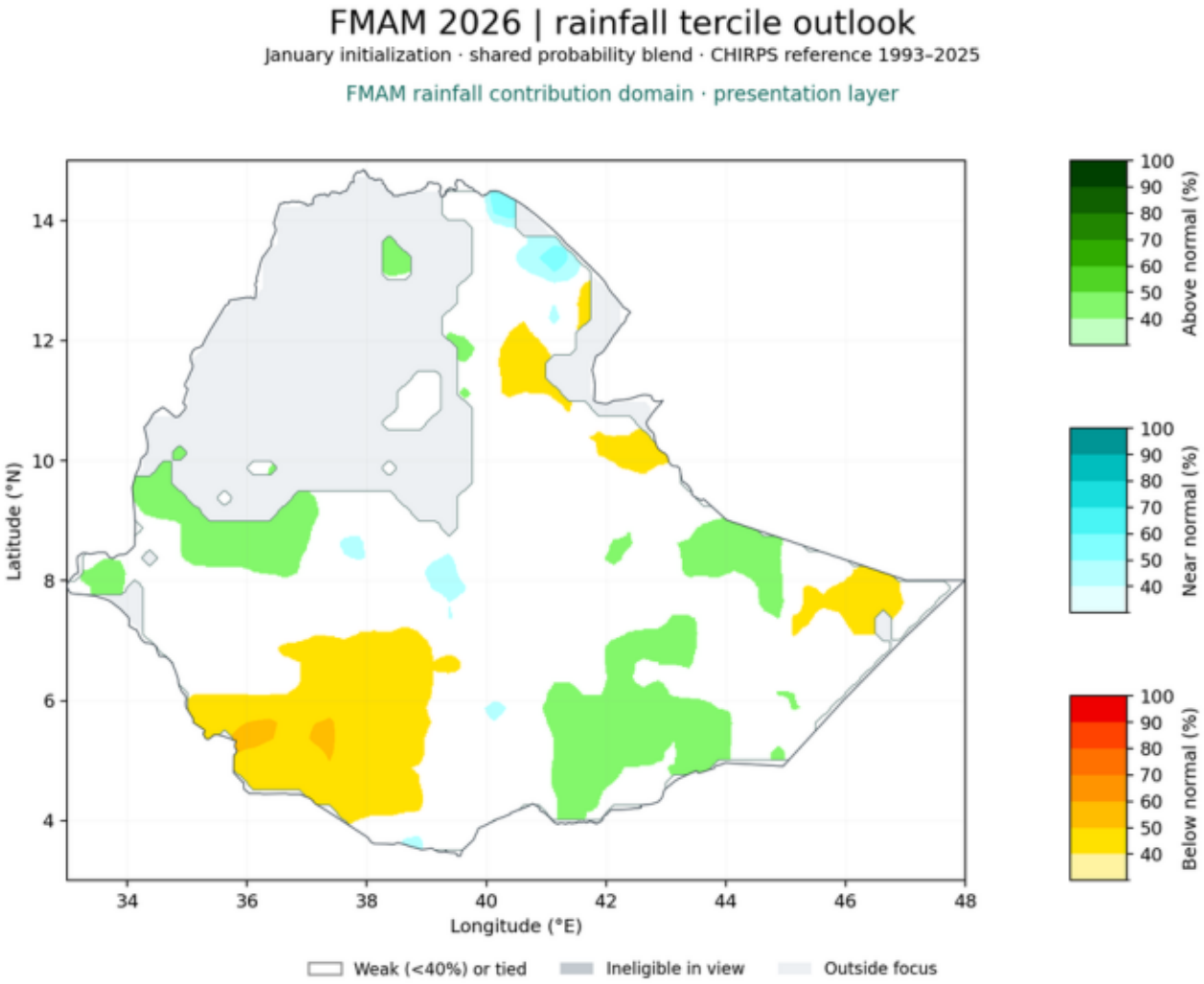
The forecast is close to climatology in the FMAM rainfall contribution domain: no tercile stands out on average. Mean forecast rainfall is 307 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 310 mm (−3 mm, −1%).

Below normal 35% **Near normal 31%** **Above normal 34%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: No clear tilt (close to climatology) (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM rainfall contribution domain): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.036, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval −0.003 to +0.071; better than climatology in 18 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12×; Gaussian σ=0.6 native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a January-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
FMAM 2026	35% / 31% / 34%	100%	−3 mm	Verification published
Feb 2026	30% / 36% / 35%	91%	+1 mm	Verification published
Mar 2026	31% / 34% / 35%	100%	+10 mm	Verification published
Apr 2026	35% / 32% / 33%	100%	−4 mm	Verification published
May 2026	36% / 35% / 30%	100%	−8 mm	Verification published

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
FMAM	+0.036 (−0.003 to +0.071)	18/24	0.171	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Feb	+0.026 (−0.006 to +0.059)	16/24	0.202	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Mar	+0.001 (−0.012 to +0.012)	12/24	0.901	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Apr	−0.002 (−0.020 to +0.013)	12/24	0.901	No demonstrated improvement over climatology
May	+0.035 (+0.009 to +0.060)	19/24	0.044	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
FMAM 2026	−0.054	−0.097	−38.1 mm	−3 / +35 mm	13% / 40% / 47%
Feb 2026	−0.036	−0.187	+2.2 mm	+1 / −1 mm	33% / 45% / 22%
Mar 2026	+0.049	+0.101	−59.0 mm	+10 / +69 mm	0% / 4% / 96%
Apr 2026	+0.015	+0.024	+17.7 mm	−4 / −22 mm	45% / 39% / 16%
May 2026	+0.033	+0.031	+3.1 mm	−8 / −11 mm	37% / 46% / 17%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 January 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 10 Oct 2026. Recalibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 when its observations for Feb 2026–May 2026 were already available (the fit itself uses 1993–2025 only): a retrospective reconstruction, not a forecast frozen before its outcome (SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v3.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v3.0 monthly listing checked 11 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026

Verification last run: 11 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.34 for FMAM) · code 1287490

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

